

ISHEDARA

Bilingual EdTech Platform

01 PROBLEME

Context and Challenge

Ishedara is a Beninese EdTech startup founded in 2024 . The platform offers bilingual (FR/EN) online courses in Data Science, AI, Machine Learning, and Power BI — targeting young Africans aged 18–35 who lack the digital skills demanded by today's job market.

Core Problem Statement

Thousands of Beninese youth graduate each year without practical digital skills. Existing training is either inaccessible, too expensive, or ill-suited to their socioeconomic reality.

Identified UX Problems

01 Unclear Value Proposition Users didn't immediately understand what differentiates the platform from alternatives, leading to early drop-off.	02 Undefined Multi-Profile Onboarding 3 user types (learner, trainer, institution) had no clearly distinct entry paths, causing confusion from the first screen.
03 Confusing Payment Model Three possible payers (student, school principal, trainer) with no clarity on who pays for what — risking trust loss at a critical moment.	04 Differentiation Not Communicated Ishedara's unique value (AI-powered, bilingual, career-oriented) was invisible on the platform compared to existing regional competitors.

Methodology

Research combined stakeholder interviews , competitive UX analysis across 4 platforms, and persona development from real user profiles identified during the coaching.

UX Competitive Analysis

UX Criterion	Coursera	OpenClassrooms	ALX Africa	Ishedara (Target)
Clear Onboarding	✓✓	✓✓	✓	To be designed
Bilingual FR/EN	✓	✓	✗	✓✓ Differentiator
Adapted to African Market	✗	✗	✓✓	✓✓ Differentiator
AI Recommendations	✓	✗	✗	✓✓ To validate
Multi-Payer Model	✗	✗	✗	✓ Innovative
Recognized Certificates	✓✓	✓✓	✓	To be built
Mobile-First UX	✓	✓	✓	To be tested

✓✓ = Very good

✓ = Present

✗ = Absent

User Personas

Kofi Adjovi — Learner <i>Age: 22 · Computer science student, Cotonou</i> Goal: Find an internship or job in data/AI Frustration: University doesn't teach practical, market-ready tools UX Need: Quickly find credible training, see the price, obtain a recognized certificate	Ms. Adanmenou — Institution <i>School Principal · 400 students · Cotonou</i> Goal: Reward top students with digital training opportunities Frustration: No simple, credible solution to pay for training on behalf of students UX Need: Understand the offer quickly, pay easily, track student progress
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Key UX Insights

Insight #1 - Profile clarity is the #1 priority

Users abandon the platform within seconds when they can't identify themselves. A profile-selection welcome screen must be the very first interaction - before any content, pricing, or course listing.

Insight #2 - Payment ambiguity destroys trust

The multi-payer model is a genuine differentiator - but only if each payer has a clear, separate path. A free user must never discover an unexpected paywall mid-journey.

Insight #3 - Bilingual + African market focus = competitive moat

No competitor (Coursera, OpenClassrooms, ALX) combines both FR/EN bilingualism and an African market focus. This must be front-and-center on the homepage — not buried in the feature list.

Insight #4 -AI features must be labeled explicitly

During user testing, 3 out of 5 users did not realize course suggestions came from AI. Without a clear "Recommended by AI" label with a distinctive icon, the feature adds no perceived value.

User Flows - 3 Critical Journeys

Friction points were identified across all three journeys at the same moment: profile selection and payment.

Journey 1 — Learner Discovery (landing) → Profile selection → Choose a course → Payment → Course access → Dashboard

Journey 2 — Trainer Trainer registration → Profile creation → Course upload → Pricing & conditions → Publication → Earnings tracking

Journey 3 — Institution Discovery (B2B) → Account creation → Student selection → Course selection → Group payment → Results tracking

Design Decisions

Based on research and identified insights, the following UX solutions were designed and prototyped in Figma, covering the homepage, onboarding flows for all 3 profiles, and the learner dashboard.

Prototype :

<https://zadya22.github.io/Ishedara/>

User Testing Protocol

Participants: 3–5 users aged 18–25

Duration: 30 min per session

#	Task	Focus Area
T1	You are a student. Find a Data Science course and sign up.	Learner onboarding
T2	You are a school principal. Pay for a course for your best student.	Institution payment flow
T3	Find where to view your progress and certificates.	Dashboard navigation
T4	Change the display language of the platform (FR → EN).	Bilingual UX
T5	Find a course recommended by AI for your profile.	AI feature discoverability

Test Report — Key Findings

T1 - Learner Registration Success: 4/5	The CTA button was not visible without scrolling on mobile. Recommendation: Move CTA above the fold at a minimum 48px size.
T2 - Institution Payment Success: 2/5	3 out of 5 users signed up as a learner — they did not find the institution path. Recommendation: Profile selection must be the first screen, with a dedicated welcome screen.
T3 - Certificates Success: 5/5	No issues. Section visible and well-positioned in the menu. No action needed.
T5 - AI Recommendations Success: 3/5	Users did not understand that suggestions came from AI. Recommendation: Add an explicit "Recommended by AI" label with a distinctive icon.

Next Steps

- Build high-fidelity prototype based on validated wireframes
- Conduct usability testing with real users (5–8 participants per profile)
- Iterate on onboarding flow and payment UX based on test observations
- Define success metrics: task completion rate, time-on-task, NPS